

# » HARVINDER SINGH

**Category:** Archery (Men's Individual Recurve Open)

Harvinder Singh entered annals of sporting folklore by becoming the first Indian to win a medal in para archery — a bronze in the men's individual compound open category. Three years later, he upgraded that medal to a historic gold, keeping calm and seeing off formidable opponents and his own nerves to finish on the top step of the podium.

Harvinder was born to a farming family in Haryana's Kaithal district. When he was just a year and a half old, he contracted dengue. A local doctor administered injections, which had an adverse effect on him, leading to a loss of function in his legs. While Harvinder worked his way back to mobility, the incident left him with permanently impaired movement.

Harvinder found his calling in archery after being inspired by following the 2012 London Paralympics. His first major success in the sport was a gold medal in the 2018 Jakarta Asian Para Games.

The COVID-19 pandemic impacted his career trajectory too, like it did for scores of athletes around the world, but Harvinder was determined to keep perfecting his skills in archery. He requested his father to help him turn their farm into an archery range so he could keep training. The hard work paid off when he clinched bronze in Tokyo.

Between the Tokyo and Paris Summer Games, Harvinder won bronze in the Hangzhou Asian Games men's team event in 2022 and a silver in the Asian Para Archery Championship in 2023.

While he went from strength to strength in sporting merit, Harvinder also balanced his academic pursuits on the side, doing a doctorate in economics from Punjabi University in Patiala.



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